political – between those who more or less stood for British domination in India and others who desired to end it. That nationalist issue still dominates the field and is likely to do so as long as India remains politically unfree. But today other issues have also assumed prominence – social and economic. If radical political change was feared by the moderate and socially backward elements much more are they terrified by the prospect of social and economic change. Indeed it is the fear of the latter that has reacted on the political issue and made many a so-called advanced politician retrace his steps. He has in some cases become, frankly, a reactionary in politics, or a camouflaged reactionary like the communalists, or an open champion of his class interest and vested rights, like the big zamindars and taluqadars and industrialists.

I have no doubt that this process will continue and will lead to the toning down of communal and religious animosities, to Hindu-Muslim unity – of a kind. The communalists of various groups, in spite of their mutual hostility, will embrace each other like long-lost brothers and swear fealty in a new joint campaign against those who are out for radical change, politically or socially or economically. The new alignment will be a healthier one and the issues will be clearer. The indications towards some such grouping are already visible, though they will take some time to develop.

Sir Mohamad Iqbal, the champion of the solidarity of Islam, is in cordial agreement with orthodox Hindus in some of their most reactionary demands. He writes: ‘I very much appreciate the orthodox Hindus’ demands for protection against religious reformers in the new constitution. Indeed this demand ought to have been first made by the Muslims.’ He further explains that ‘the encouragement in India of religious adventurers on the ground of modern liberalism tends to make people more and more indifferent to religion and will eventually completely eliminate the important factor of religion from the life of the Indian community. The Indian mind will then seek some other substitute for religion which is likely to be nothing less than the form of atheistic materialism which has appeared in Russia.’